Product Review Template

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Purpose

A Product (Product Valuation Model, PVM) is a priced product built from components, such as a hazard curve, a recovery curve and a pricing engine. It runs on one Calculating Agent, for example QuantLib or an internal library. A component can be a model, an ML Application or an AI System.

Today a Product has no review. It has no stages, no questionnaire and no signed review report. The platform says a Product "validates through its component models" (`config/governance/_product.py`), and `Subject.reviewable()` is false for it. A Product reaches the MRC only through a sign-off request with a proposed RAG, supported by the Product Document and the product pack.

That gap matters. Each component can pass its own review while the combination is still unsound: inputs built to different conventions, a component used outside its stated limits, or a Calculating Agent nobody has looked at. **This template proposes a Product review that asks only what the component reviews cannot answer.**

- **The owner** keeps the Product record, lists its components and their roles, and answers the Product review questions.
- **The reviewer** must be someone other than the owner. They give a verdict on each answer, agree each stage and sign off.
- **The MRC** receives the report and decides the risk rating, as it does today through the sign-off request.

How the review runs

The seven stages, their order and their statuses stay the same as a model's (`REVIEW_STAGES` in `config/governance/_review.py`). Only the third stage's label changes, as it does for ML Applications and AI Systems. Stage 4 is the one real difference: a Product has no weaknesses register of its own, so the stage reads its components' weaknesses and its own operational events.

#	Stage	What is agreed for a Product
1	Preliminary documents	The pack: the Product Document, each component's Model Risk Document (or ML Application or AI System document), the product's own attachments, and the review brief (trigger, scope, expected completion)
2	Assumptions	The Product's assumptions register: what holds across components, for example a shared curve date, day count or calibration set
3	The Product review questions	A verdict on each of the 10 answers
4	Component weaknesses	The weaknesses of each component as they bear on its role in this Product, plus the Product's operational-event log
5	Limitations of use	The Product's limitations register, checked against each component's own limitations
6	Monitoring approach	The Product's monitoring approach and its dated Monitoring documents
7	Remediation	The Product's remediation register: what is outstanding, who owns it, by when

The workflow rules are the same as a model's:

- **The review can be reopened.** An agreed stage can be reopened.
- **Challenge is recorded permanently.** Every stage has a record of challenge that cannot be edited.
- **Sign-off is gated.** Sign-off is blocked while any stage is unagreed or any challenge is open.
- **Components come first.** A Product review should not start while a component's own review is overdue or unsigned. The reviewer would otherwise be judging the combination of things nobody has judged.
- **Changes trigger a review.** A component added, removed or replaced, or a change of Calculating Agent, is the Product's equivalent of a new version. It should start a review with the New version trigger.

The template, section by section

The report has the same seven parts as the Model, ML Application and AI System templates. What changes is the Product-specific content in each, and above all the component table.

Part	Section	What it contains for a Product	Filled by
A	Identification	Product ID and name, and the derived identifier; division, line of business and functional group; **Calculating Agent**; status; owner, reviewer, trigger and scope; tier, materiality and complexity with their rationales; current RAG rating; last MRC sign-off and meeting	Owner, platform
A	Components	One row per component: its kind (Model, ML Application or AI System), type, ID and name, its role in the Product, **its own current RAG and the date of its last signed review**	Platform
B	Documents reviewed	The Product Document as issued for the review; each component document read, with its version; the Product's own attachments; Monitoring documents, each with its date	Owner, with the reviewer marking each read
	Challenge in summary	Challenges raised, answered and still open, in total and by stage	Platform
C	The Product review questions	For each of the 10: the owner's status and rationale, the reviewer's verdict and comment, and the register or component it rests on	Owner, then reviewer

Part	Section	What it contains for a Product	Filled by
D	Findings	Assumptions; component weaknesses as they bear on this Product; operational events; limitations of use; RACI; monitoring; remediation	Owner proposes, reviewer agrees
E	Reviewer's opinion	Fit for use, Fit for use with conditions, or Not fit for use; the conditions as remediation items; the recommended RAG rating	Reviewer, at sign-off
F	Record and attestation	The full record of challenge, stage agreements, final commentary, and who signed and when	Platform, reviewer

The component table is what makes a Product review different. A Product's RAG cannot sensibly be lower than its weakest material component's. When it is, the rating rationale (part A) has to say why, and question 6 is where the reviewer tests that.

The Product review questions and their evidence

The proposal is 10 questions, all new: no Product questionnaire exists on the platform today. Four are the common questions every ML Application and AI System is already asked (`COMMON_QUESTIONS` in `config/governance/_questions_common.py`), with the same wording. The other six are about the combination. None of them repeats a component's own questions on accuracy, data quality or benchmarking: question 5 checks that those questions have been answered elsewhere.

#	Topic	Question	Evidence the reviewer checks
1	Use Case	What decision or task does this support, and what is it explicitly not to be used for?	Description; Product limitations register; the Limitations stage
2	Human Oversight	Who reviews what it produces, on what basis, and would they catch it being wrong?	The RACI register; compensating controls on limitations

#	Topic	Question	Evidence the reviewer checks
3	Explainability	Can a particular output be explained to the person affected by it, and to a regulator?	The Product Document; price and risk attribution to components, if filed
4	Drift and Monitoring	What would show that it has stopped working, and who is watching for it?	Monitoring approach; dated Monitoring documents; the Monitoring stage
5	Component Coverage	Is every component on its register, reviewed and signed off, and within its review date?	The component table (part A); each component's last signed review and next review date
6	Aggregate Risk	Does combining these components compound their weaknesses, and does the Product's rating reflect its weakest material component?	Component RAGs; the Product's rating and rating rationale; the Component weaknesses stage
7	Fitness for Role	Is each component used within its own limitations of use, in the role this Product gives it?	Each component's limitations against its role in the component table; the Limitations stage
8	Integration and Consistency	Where one component feeds another, do they agree on conventions, market data, calibration dates and units?	The Product assumptions register; the model map
9	Calculating Agent	Is the platform it is priced on appropriate for this Product, version-controlled, and tested on this Product's payoffs?	The Calculating Agent binding; the Product's test and implementation documents
10	Operational Events	What has gone wrong in production, what caused it, and has each event been closed?	The operational-event log; the remediation register

Two questions share a judgement with a stage, as Assumptions and question 6 do for a model. Question 6 goes with the Component weaknesses stage, and question 7 with the Limitations stage. A reviewer who agrees the stage and challenges the question has

contradicted themselves.

Bias and Fairness, the fifth common question, is left out. A PVM values instruments, not people. A Product that does affect individuals, for example retail pricing, should add it back. No question asks for overall risk: the reviewer's opinion (part E) gives that conclusion.

How the review relates to the components, the Product Document and the pack

The Product review sits on top of the component reviews and does not replace any of them.

- **The component reviews are the evidence.** Each component's signed review answers its own questions. The Product review cites those reviews and does not reopen them. A finding about a component goes back to that component's remediation register, not the Product's.
- **The Product Document is the owner's account.** It is generated on request from the record (`_report_product.py`) and prints the components, classification, bindings and registers. The review should cite the copy issued for it (part B), because a later copy will show later components.
- **The product pack is the reviewer's reading.** It bundles the Product Document with the full pack of every component model, built at packing time, and `CONTENTS.txt` lists what was recorded but missing. Today it packs model components only. ML Application and AI System components are skipped (`pack.py`), so a reviewer of a mixed Product has to collect those documents separately.
- **The MRC sign-off is unchanged.** The request still carries a proposed RAG to the committee resolved from division and line of business. The signed review report becomes the paper it is decided on.

What exists today and what is still to build

A Product already has the record, most of the registers, the Product Document, the pack and an MRC sign-off route. It has none of the review itself. Unlike the other three templates, most of this is new build.

Part	Today	To build
Review workflow	None: `reviewable()` is false for a Product	A `product_review_questions` collection, a `REVIEW_QUESTION_COLLECTIONS` entry, review fields on the Product, and the Review tab
A Identification	On the record and in the Product Document	Print it in the review report
A Components	In the Product Document; without component RAGs or review dates	Each component's RAG and last signed review
B Documents reviewed	Product pack, model components only	ML Application and AI System documents in the pack; the issued copies listed in the report
Challenge in summary	Built for the other record types	Nothing new once the workflow exists
C The Product review questions	None	Seed the 10 at registration; existing Products keep none until their next review
D Findings	Assumptions, limitations, remediation, operational events, RACI, monitoring approach	Component weaknesses read through from the components
E Reviewer's opinion	Missing for every record type	Built once for all four
F Record and attestation	Built for the other record types	Nothing new once the workflow exists

Suggested order:

1. Part E once for all record types.
2. Turn on the review workflow for Products with the 10 questions (C).
3. The component table with RAGs and review dates (A).
4. ML Application and AI System documents in the pack (B).

The comment in `_product.py` that says Products carry no questionnaire must change in the same commit as step 2.